

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Who's paying attention to who at the party?



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can change topics.
- I can talk about social activities.
- I can talk about things that are happening now.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you attended an important event?
- How did you feel? What did you talk about?





Let's Explore!

The party's **in full swing***!

* "In full swing" means at the most effective or highest level of operation or activity.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Hey Renata. How's the party going?
- Renata:** It's in full swing, Peter! There's a lot of positive energy in here.
- Peter:** Ricardo Verde is doing a fantastic job as MC. But how's your job going? I hear you saved the day! I'm glad we avoided a disaster. Did I ever tell you about the time I got a job in Hawaii and ...
- Renata:** Stick to the point, Pete!
- Peter:** Yeah, so ... Being a doorman isn't bad. I'm getting to meet many beautiful women without seeming flirtatious.
- Renata:** You're never flirtatious. But I'm glad you're enjoying your role.
- Peter:** Speaking of roles, how's the fashion show? I just heard Miranda's modeling some of Holly's clothes.
- Renata:** Excellent vibes and a well-planned ceremony. Broadcasting both events at the same time brings an international status to Holly's clothing line.
- Peter:** Oh, while you're at it ... Have you seen Miranda?
- Renata:** She's right there ... and let me tell you, she looks tremendous! She could be a model herself.
- Peter:** Wow! She does look good. Oh, check it out ... that Ricardo guy is flirting with her. He was rude to her just the other day.
- Renata:** Showbiz, Peter. He is trying to maintain his ego. Are you jealous?
- Peter:** Me? Jealous? I'm just being protective.
- Renata:** Ok. Enough talk - let's eat!





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about the party!

Instructions: Circle the correct answer. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) Wow, this party is in full (*swing / ceremony / vibes*).
- 2) There's a lot of (*ceremony / showbiz / positive energy*) in here.
- 3) Being a doorman isn't bad, as I'm *get to* (*meet / getting to meet / positive energy*) many beautiful women.
- 4) Broadcasting the events will give Holly's international (*vibes / showbiz / status*).



Let's Practice!

How's the party going*?

*"How's (it) going" is an informal way of asking how something is progressing or how something is.

Instructions: Match the words on the right to their corresponding half on the left. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. Ricardo Verde is | a. some of Holly's clothes. |
| 2. I'm just | b. your role. |
| 3. How's your job | c. going? |
| 4. I'm glad you're enjoying | d. being protective. |
| 5. Miranda's modeling | e. doing a fantastic job. |





Extension Activity

Practice changing topics!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You are going to play a game with your partner.
- Before you start, write 4-5 different topics for a conversation on cards. Do the same for "changing the topic" expressions.
- You are going to start by telling a story about something that happened to you recently.
- Your partner will pick a "conversation card" and a "changing the topic card". He or she will change the topic of the conversation.
- Do this until you run out of cards.
- You can also use vocabulary you learned from the lesson to review words. Then, before changing topics, you also need to pick a vocabulary card and raise a new topic related to that word.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write conversation topics and expressions to change topics.

☐ ☐

I tell a story to a partner.

☐ ☐

I change topics in a conversation.

☐ ☐

I use vocabulary I learned.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- positive energy** (expression): a feeling of well-being
e.g. There's a lot of positive energy in here.
- vibe** (noun): a general feeling you get from a place
e.g. The party had a good vibe.
- status** (noun): a high social position that makes other people respect or admire you
e.g. The events will bring an international status to the Holly's clothing line.
- showbiz** (noun): the entertainment industry
e.g. This is part of showbiz, Peter.
- get to meet** (expression): to have the opportunity to interact with people
e.g. I get to meet many beautiful women here.
- ceremony** (noun): a formal public event with special traditions, actions, or words
e.g. This is a very well-planned ceremony.



Learning Points

The Present Continuous

The present continuous tense (also called the present progressive tense) is a tense commonly used in English. This is how we form and use this tense.

Form: subject + be + verb -ing

Example:

He is trying to maintain his ego.

Use:

1. We use the present continuous to talk about actions or situations which are in progress at the moment of speaking.

- *He is doing a fantastic job at the party.*
- *She's really enjoying her new role.*
- *I'm just being protective of you.*
- *He is flirting with her.*

5. We use the present continuous to talk about actions or situations which are in progress around the present time, but not necessarily at the moment of speaking.

- *I'm getting to meet a lot of people at the party.*
- *Maria is modelling some of their new clothes.*

Expressions for Changing Conversation Topics

When speaking a foreign language, especially English, it is important that you acquire a set of conversation strategies which will help you deal with the spontaneity of spoken English. A very important strategy you need to master is changing topics in a conversation. Here are a few expressions you can use to change the subject of a conversation.

- *But ... + question.*
- *Funny you should say that. Did I ever tell you about the time + clause?*
- *Speaking of + noun, + new topic.*
- *Oh, while you're at it, + new topic.*
- *Oh, + new topic*

Examples:

• **Amy:** *Hey, are you enjoying the party?*

Brian: *Yes, but ... is Maria coming?*

• **Amy:** *There's a lot of good food here.*

Brian: *Speaking of food, did I tell you about the new Japanese restaurant downtown?*

• **Oh,** *check it out! Mark is chatting with the secretary.*

